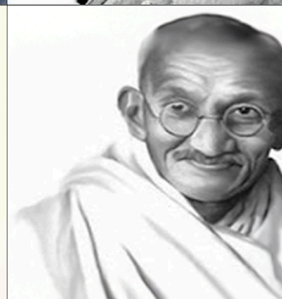


General Knowledge

Modern History

STUDY NOTES

Caste Movements



Caste Movements



The **Caste Movements** in India during the late 19th and early 20th centuries played a significant role in challenging the traditional caste hierarchy and addressing the social discrimination prevalent in Indian society. These movements arose as a response to the oppressive practices of caste discrimination and were spearheaded by reformers and social activists from various regions of India.

These movements aimed to address issues such as **Brahminical dominance**, the exclusion of lower castes from socio-political rights, and the struggle for **educational and social empowerment of marginalized communities**. Reformers like **Jyotiba Phule**, **Dr. B.R. Ambedkar**, and **Periyar** led campaigns to uplift lower castes, and their efforts laid the foundation for socio-economic changes in India. For example, the **Satyashodhak Samaj** founded by **Phule** in **1873** sought to dismantle the caste system and advocated for education and rights for women and the lower castes.

Movement	Region	Year	Causes & Consequences	Personalities
Satyashodhak Movement	Maharashtra	1873	Against brahminic domination; for the emancipation of low castes,	Jyotiba Phule

			untouchables, and widows.	
Aravippuram Movement	Kerala	1888	For the rights of the depressed classes (especially the Ezhavas or Iravas); Sri Narayana Dharma Paripalana Yogum was set up in 1902-03.	Shri Narayana Guru
Justice Party Movement	Madras	1916	Against Brahmin domination in government service, education, and politics; resulted in a 1930 Government Order providing reservations.	Dr. T.M. Nair, P. Tyagaraja Chetti, C.N. Mudalair
Nair Movement	Kerala	1891	Against Brahmin domination; Malayali Memorial was formed in 1891; the Nair Service Society was established in 1914.	C.V. Raman Pillai, K. Rama Krishna Pillai, M. Padmanabha Pillai
Self-Respect Movement	Tamil Nadu	1925	Against caste bias by Brahmins; Periyar launched the journal Kudi Arasu in 1910.	E. V. Ramaswami Naicker (Periyar)
Nadar Movement	Tamil Nadu	Early 20th century	Against social bias; promoted educational and social welfare among Nadars; Nadar Mahajan Sangam was formed in 1910.	
Depressed Classes (Mahars) Movement	Maharashtra	1924	For the upliftment of untouchables; the Depressed Classes Institution was founded in 1924; several organizations and publications by B.R. Ambedkar.	B.R. Ambedkar
Congress Harijan Movement	Nationwide	1917 onwards	To elevate the social status of lower classes; All-India Anti-Untouchability League was formed in 1932; Gandhi's Harijan Weekly was launched in 1933.	M.K. Gandhi (Mahatma Gandhi)

Kaivartas Movement	Midnapore, Bengal	1897 onwards	Against social bias; promoted social upliftment; Jati Nirdharani Sabha (1897) and Mahishya Samiti (1901) were established.	
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